

Remittance Apps Serving Africans Abroad: 2025 Report

Coverage: Top 10 African Economies by GDP · Average Transfer Rates & Fees · App Profiles · Corridor Data

Note: This is an updated edition (May 2026) reflecting full-year 2025 central-bank figures (replacing earlier 2025 projections) and post-publication developments at LemFi, Tether/stablecoin integration, and other apps.

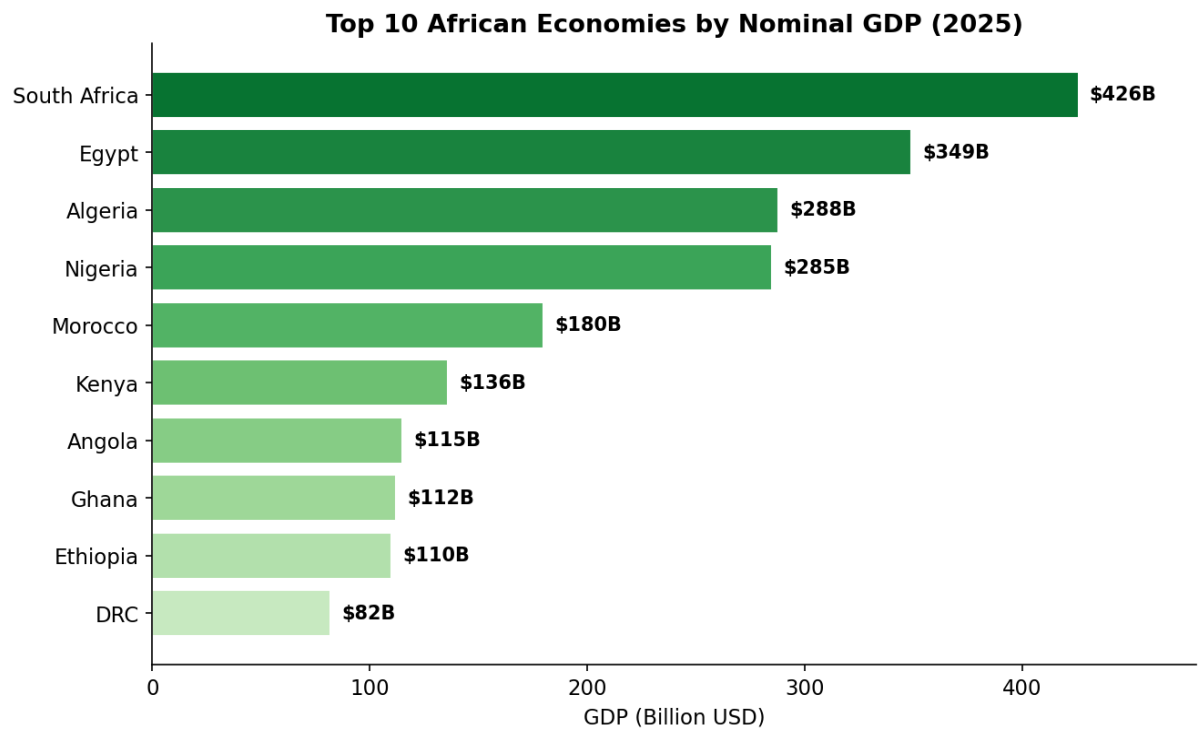
Executive Summary

Remittance flows to Africa reached historic highs in 2025. World Bank data confirmed Sub-Saharan Africa received approximately **\$105 billion** in remittances — surpassing both foreign direct investment and official development assistance as a source of external finance. Globally, the average cost of sending \$200 stood at **6.36%** in Q3 2025 (World Bank Remittance Prices Worldwide Q3 2025), while Sub-Saharan Africa remained the most expensive receiving region at **8.46%** — more than double the 3% UN SDG target for 2030.

A new generation of diaspora-focused fintech apps — LemFi, TapTap Send, NALA, Sendwave, and others — is aggressively undercutting traditional operators, with several corridors now available at under 2% total cost. Understanding which apps offer the best rates for which countries is essential for the 40+ million Africans living abroad who send money home regularly.

The GDP ranking determines economic weight and correlates with diaspora size, remittance volumes, and the competitive depth of available services for each corridor.

Part 1 — Top 10 African Countries by GDP (2025)



Rank	Country	GDP 2025 (USD bn)	GDP Share (Africa)	Remittance Inflows 2025
1	South Africa	\$426.4	13.9%	~\$1.0B (large sender)

2	Egypt	\$349.3	11.4%	\$41.5B
3	Algeria	\$288.0	9.4%	~\$1.9B
4	Nigeria	\$285.0	9.3%	\$21.8B
5	Morocco	\$179.6	5.9%	\$13.2B
6	Kenya	\$136.0	4.4%	\$7.8B
7	Angola	\$115.2	3.8%	~\$0.5B
8	Ethiopia	\$109.5	3.6%	~\$1.5B
9	Ghana	\$112.0	3.7%	~\$7.8B
10	DRC	\$82.3	2.7%	~\$1.4B

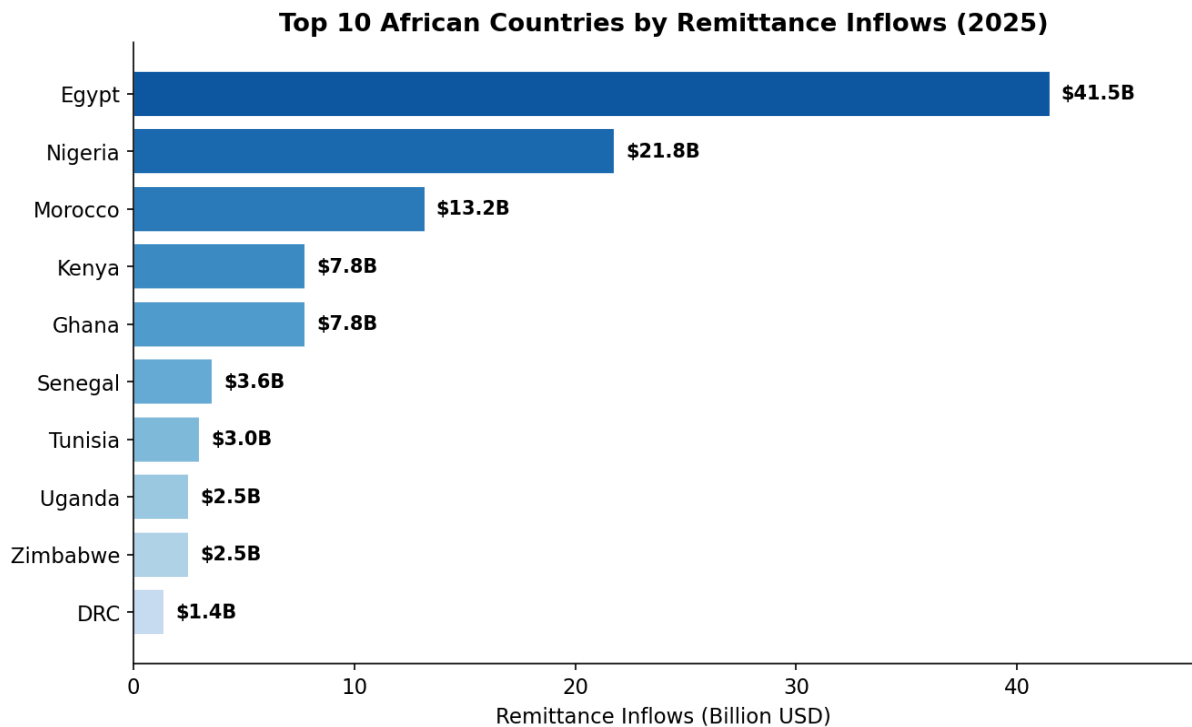
Sources: StatisticsTimes IMF Data 2025; Central Bank of Nigeria (2025 actuals); Central Bank of Egypt (2025 actuals); Daba Finance; World Bank.

Note: South Africa is unique in this list — it is the continent's largest GDP economy but is also Africa's **largest remittance sender** to other African countries, rather than a primary receiver from the global diaspora.

What changed since the prior edition: Nigeria's remittance inflow line has been revised from the early-2025 projection of \$23B down to the **\$21.806B actual** reported by the Central Bank of Nigeria for full-year 2025 (essentially flat vs. \$21.81B in 2024). Egypt's \$41.5B is now confirmed as a final figure — a 40.5% year-on-year jump from \$29.6B in 2024, making 2025 a record year.

Part 2 — Remittance Inflows: Who Receives the Most?

The top GDP countries by economic size do not always align with top remittance receivers. Egypt dominates, driven by millions of workers in the Gulf.



Key dynamics:

- **Egypt** leads Africa with a record **\$41.5 billion** in 2025, up 40.5% from \$29.6B in 2024 — the highest annual total ever recorded, per the Central Bank of Egypt. December 2025 alone delivered \$4.0B, a single-month record. FY 2024–25 totalled \$36.5B.
- **Nigeria** received **\$21.8 billion** in 2025 per CBN data (essentially flat vs. 2024's \$21.81B), down from the \$23B figure projected mid-year. Formal-channel inflows continued to surge under CBN reforms, monthly inflows rising from roughly \$200M to roughly \$600M.
- **Kenya** saw remittances surpass 1 trillion Kenyan shillings (~\$7.8B) by November 2025, propelled by a fast-growing diaspora in North America and Europe.
- **Ghana** matched Kenya at an estimated \$7.8 billion, benefiting from large communities in the UK, US, and Europe.
- **Morocco** received \$13.2 billion, making its diaspora — primarily in France, Spain, and Italy — among the most active remitters globally.

Part 3 — The Biggest Remittance Apps Serving Africans Abroad

Overview

Ten major apps dominate remittance flows from the African diaspora in Europe and North America. They fall into three categories:

1. **Africa-first fintechs** built specifically for diaspora communities (LemFi, TapTap Send, NALA, Sendwave, Chipper Cash, Eversend)
2. **Global remittance MTOs** with strong Africa coverage (Remitly, WorldRemit, Western Union)
3. **Multi-purpose financial platforms** (Wise/TransferWise)

3.1 Africa-First Fintechs

LemFi (formerly Lemonade Finance)

Founded: 2021 | **HQ:** UK | **Users:** 2M+ (up from 1M+ at the start of 2025)

Sending from: UK, US, Canada, France, Germany, Spain, Belgium, Italy, Ireland, Netherlands, Portugal

Key African destinations: Nigeria, Ghana, Kenya, Uganda, Tanzania, Senegal, Ivory Coast, Cameroon, Morocco, Ethiopia, Rwanda, Benin

Fee model: Zero fees on most African corridors; FX margin-based revenue

Standout: Raised \$53M Series B in January 2025, bringing total funding to \$85M+. Committed **£100M to global expansion** in April 2026 following the UK–Nigeria Enhanced Trade and Investment Partnership. Took strategic investment from **Tether** (May 2026) to integrate USDT as a settlement layer across Africa and Asia — positioning LemFi as the first major African-diaspora fintech with stablecoin rails at scale. Crossed \$1B in monthly transaction volume. Consistently top-rated for GBP→NGN and EUR→NGN corridors. Multi-currency wallet (USD, GBP, EUR, CAD).

Transfer speed: 3–5 minutes on average

Regulation: FCA (UK), FINTRAC (Canada), CFSB-sponsored (US)

TapTap Send

Founded: 2018 | **HQ:** UK

Sending from: UK, US, Canada, EU (Austria, Belgium, France, Germany, Greece, Ireland, Italy, Netherlands, Norway, Poland, Portugal, Romania, Spain, Sweden), UAE, South Korea

Key African destinations: Nigeria, Ghana, Kenya, Tanzania, Uganda, Senegal, Ivory Coast, Cameroon, DRC, Ethiopia, Morocco, South Africa, Rwanda, Zambia, Zimbabwe, Tunisia, and 20+ more

Fee model: Zero transfer fees; small FX margin (typically 0.97–1.5% on Africa corridors)

Standout: Among the broadest African country coverage of any app; UK→Ghana corridor at 4.24% average total cost, with TapTap Send recorded at just **0.97% total cost** in Q3 2025 on that corridor.

Transfer speed: ~90% of transfers within minutes

Regulation: FCA authorised (UK)

NALA

Founded: 2017 (Tanzania) | **HQ:** UK

Sending from: UK, US, EU

Key African destinations: Nigeria, Kenya, Tanzania, Senegal, Uganda, Côte d'Ivoire, Rwanda, Mozambique, Ethiopia (11 African markets)

Fee model: Transparent upfront rates; low FX margin model

Standout: Raised \$40M Series A in July 2024; expanded to Philippines and Pakistan in January 2025. Total processed volume has now passed **\$1B+ across Asia and Africa**. Best known for East Africa corridors and direct M-Pesa integration. Also building **Rafiki**, a B2B payments-infrastructure layer used by other fintechs (including TransferGo) for Africa payouts.

Transfer speed: Minutes (bank and mobile money)

Coverage note: Deepest East Africa integration; limited North/Southern Africa presence

Sendwave (a WorldRemit Group company)

Founded: 2014 | **HQ:** US

Sending from: US, UK, Canada, EU, Australia

Key African destinations: Nigeria, Ghana, Kenya, Tanzania, Uganda, Senegal, Cameroon, Ethiopia, Liberia, Sierra Leone

Fee model: Zero transfer fee; small FX margin (typically 0.38–1.5%)

Standout: Cheapest provider for UK→Kenya in Q3 2025 at just **0.38–0.42% total cost**. Focused entirely on mobile money delivery.

Transfer speed: Instant to most destinations

Note: Acquired by WorldRemit in 2020; operates as independent app

Chipper Cash

Founded: 2018 | **HQ:** US | **Co-founders:** Ham Serunjogi (Uganda), Maijid Moujaled (Ghana)

Sending from: US, UK, Europe

Key African destinations: Ghana, Uganda, Nigeria, Kenya, Tanzania, Rwanda, South Africa, Zambia

Fee model: Free P2P between users; FX margin on cross-currency transfers

Standout: Pan-African P2P focus; instant transfers between Chipper accounts; strong for intra-Africa transfers

Eversend

Founded: 2019 | **HQ:** London / Kampala

Sending from: Europe, UK

Key African destinations: Uganda, Nigeria, Kenya, Ghana, Rwanda, Tanzania, Senegal

Fee model: Low fees with competitive FX rates; multi-currency wallet

Standout: Europe-based Africans' go-to; multi-currency accounts

3.2 Global MTOs with Strong Africa Coverage

Remitly

Key corridors: US/UK/EU → Nigeria, Kenya, Ghana, South Africa, Morocco, Egypt, Ethiopia

Fee model: Dual-speed tiers — "Express" (faster, higher fee) and "Economy" (3–5 days, lower fee)

Cost: Exchange rate markup 1%–3.7%; flat fee \$0–\$6 depending on tier and destination

Standout: Cost leader for Nigeria in 24.23% of Monito comparison queries; UK→Kenya total cost 1.77%; strong for high-value transfers (up to \$100,000)

Coverage: 170+ countries, 100+ currencies

WorldRemit

Key African corridors: 40+ African countries; UK, US, EU, Canada, Australia

Fee model: Flat fees \$1–\$5 + FX margin 0.5–4% depending on payout method

Payout options: Bank deposit, mobile money, cash pickup, airtime top-up — the most diverse in the market

Standout: Cheapest provider on US→Nigeria in Q3 2025 at **-0.49% total cost** (better than mid-market rate);

UK→Kenya at 1.18% total cost; strong for rural/unbanked recipients via cash pickup

Coverage: 130+ countries, 50+ sending countries

Western Union

Key African corridors: 50+ African countries; global coverage

Fee model: Higher fees (\$1.99–\$8+) + FX margin 2–10%; cash pickup available globally

Standout: Unmatched cash pickup network; critical for recipients without bank accounts or mobile money

Cost: Higher average cost across digital and in-person channels; not recommended for cost-conscious digital transfers

3.3 Multi-Purpose Financial Platform

Wise (formerly TransferWise)

Key African corridors: Nigeria, Kenya, South Africa, Ghana, Morocco, Egypt

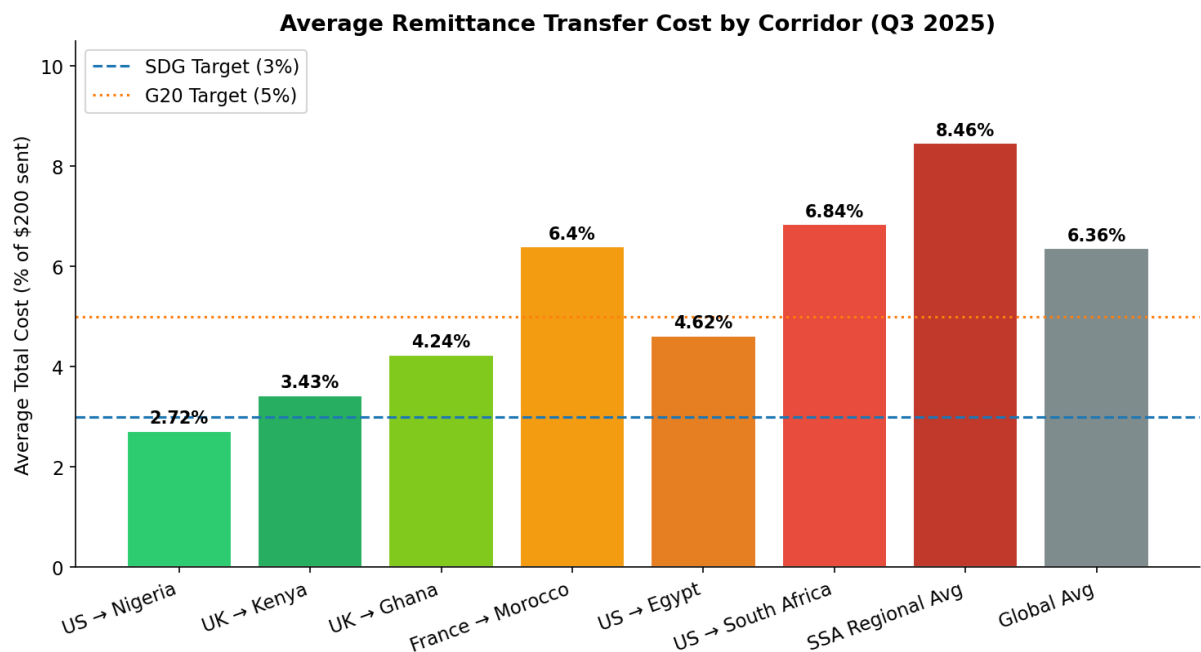
Fee model: Mid-market FX rate + transparent percentage fee (from 0.57%); no exchange rate markup

Cost to Kenya (UK): Wise shown at 2.67–4.87% total cost in Q3 2025 on UK→Kenya corridor, vs. Sendwave at 0.38% — reflecting Wise's transparent fixed fee vs. hidden FX margin tradeoff

Standout: The most transparent fee structure globally; mid-market rate means what you see is what recipients get. Best for bank-to-bank, large-amount transfers. Not ideal for mobile money delivery.

Part 4 — Corridor Transfer Costs: Average Rates 2025

This section synthesizes World Bank Remittance Prices Worldwide Q3 2025 data for key Africa-bound corridors.



Corridor-by-Corridor Breakdown

Nigeria (Top SSA receiver)

Corridor	Q3 2025 Avg Cost	Cheapest Provider	Cheapest Cost	Source
US → Nigeria	2.72%	WorldRemit	-0.49%	World Bank
UK → Nigeria	~3–4%	LemFi / TapTap Send	~0%	Keble Newsletter
EU → Nigeria	~3–5%	LemFi / TransferGo	~1%	Roze Remit

Nigeria is the most competitive African corridor globally. The US→Nigeria average of 2.72% beats the global average and nearly meets the SDG 3% target — driven by Central Bank of Nigeria policy changes in 2024 requiring NGN-denominated payouts (ending the USD-settlement era) and fierce fintech competition. WorldRemit and MoneyGram recorded negative or near-zero costs (better than mid-market) on certain transactions.

Kenya

Corridor	Q3 2025 Avg Cost	Cheapest Provider	Cheapest Cost	Source
UK → Kenya	3.43%	Sendwave	0.38%	World Bank

Sendwave dominates the UK→Kenya corridor thanks to direct M-Pesa integration with near-zero FX margin. ACE Money Transfer (1.05%) and WorldRemit (1.18%) are strong budget alternatives. Wise (2.67–4.87%) is the highest-transparency option but not cheapest. The 3.43% average is below the global average of 6.36%.

Ghana

Corridor	Q3 2025 Avg Cost	Cheapest Provider	Cheapest Cost	Source
UK → Ghana	4.24%	CashMinute	-0.03%	World Bank

Notable providers: TapTap Send (0.97%), Remitly (0.92%), WorldRemit (1.24%), Sendwave (1.30%). The corridor is competitive but still above the 3% SDG target on average. Western Union remains expensive at 4.45–16%+ depending on method.

Morocco

Corridor	Q3 2025 Avg Cost	Cheapest Provider	Cheapest Cost	Source
France → Morocco	6.40%	Various (lowest ~1.55%)	1.55%	World Bank

Despite Morocco being the third-largest remittance receiver in Africa (\$13.2B), the France→Morocco corridor remains significantly more expensive than West African or East African corridors. The 6.40% average exceeds both the global average and G20 targets. Belgium→Algeria and France→Algeria corridors are flagged as having no qualifying low-cost SmaRT services at all.

Egypt

Corridor	Q3 2025 Avg Cost	Cheapest Provider	Cheapest Cost	Source
US → Egypt	4.62%	Multiple (lowest ~1.90%)	1.90%	World Bank

The US→Egypt corridor improved from 5.59% in Q4 2024 to 4.62% in Q3 2025, reflecting increased fintech competition. Egypt remains the continent's largest remittance receiver yet lacks the same fintech-driven corridor competition seen in Nigeria or Kenya — a notable gap given the record \$41.5B Egypt received in 2025.

South Africa

Corridor	Q3 2025 Avg Cost	Cheapest Provider	Cheapest Cost	Source
US → South Africa	6.84%	Multiple (lowest ~1.92%)	1.92%	World Bank
South Africa (as receiver)	5.96%	—	—	World Bank Q3 2025
South Africa (as sender)	15.65%	—	—	World Bank Q3 2025

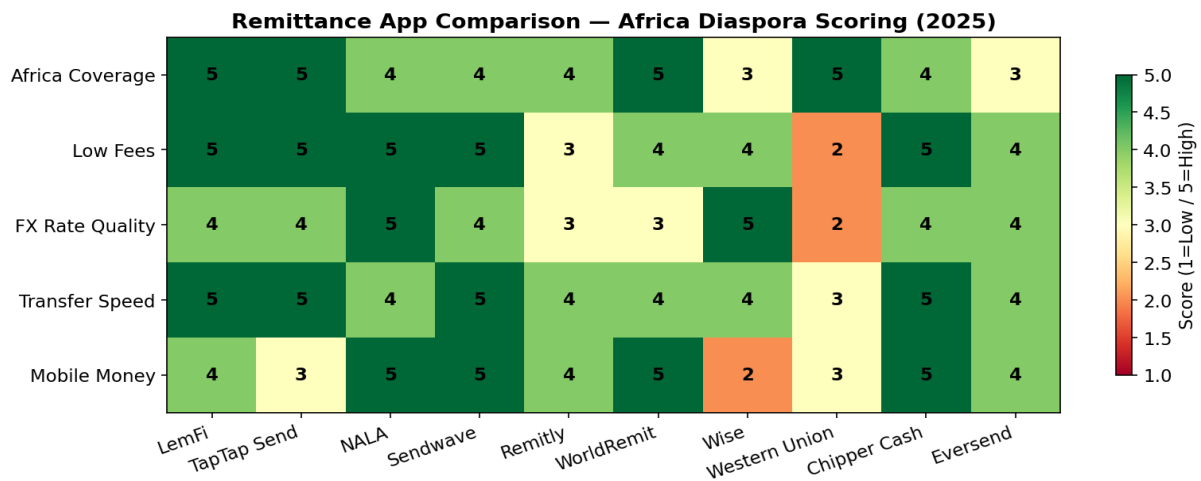
South Africa is a global outlier: sending money from South Africa costs 15.65% on average — by far the most expensive G20 sending country, more than 3× the G20 average. Receiving is comparatively competitive at 5.96%. For Africans from other countries who live in South Africa and send remittances home, this represents a significant financial burden.

Summary Cost Table — All Key Corridors

Country	Best Available App	Best Rate	Corridor Avg Q3 2025	Global Avg
Nigeria	WorldRemit / LemFi	~0%	2.72%	6.36%
Kenya	Sendwave	0.38%	3.43%	6.36%
Ghana	TapTap Send / Remitly	~0.92%	4.24%	6.36%
Egypt	Various MTOs	~1.90%	4.62%	6.36%
Morocco	Various	~1.55%	6.40%	6.36%
South Africa	Various	~1.92%	6.84%	6.36%
Algeria	Limited digital options	High	High	6.36%
Ethiopia	LemFi / WorldRemit	~1–2%	~5–6%*	6.36%
Angola	Very limited	High	High	6.36%
DRC	TapTap Send / WorldRemit	~2–3%	~6–7%*	6.36%

**Estimated based on regional SSA average; corridor-specific data not available from World Bank Q3 2025. Sources: World Bank RPW Q3 2025, World Bank Corridor Data.*

Part 5 — App Comparison Matrix



App	Africa Countries	Fee Model	Best For	FX Rate	Speed	Mobile Money	Avg Cost
LemFi	15+	Zero fees	Nigeria, francophone Africa	Competitive	Minutes	Yes	0–1.5%
TapTap Send	25+	Zero fees	Ghana, Nigeria, E. Africa	Competitive	Minutes	Yes	0.97–2%
NALA	11	Low transparent fee	East Africa (KE, TZ, UG)	Excellent	Minutes	Yes (M-Pesa)	0.5–2%
Sendwave	10	Zero fee	Kenya, West Africa	Good	Instant	Yes	0.38–1.5%
Chipper Cash	8	Free P2P	Pan-Africa P2P	Good	Instant	Yes	0–1%
Remitly	15+	Variable tiers	Nigeria, large amounts	Moderate	Mins–days	Yes	1–4%
WorldRemit	40+	Low flat fee	Broad coverage, cash pickup	Moderate	Mins–days	Yes	1–6%
Wise	6–8 key	% fee, mid-market rate	Transparency, bank transfer	Excellent	Mins–days	Limited	1.5–5%
Western Union	50+	Higher fee	Cash pickup, rural	Below avg	Minutes (cash)	Limited	3–10%+
Eversend	8	Low fee	Europe-based Africans	Good	Fast	Yes	0.5–2%

Part 6 — Key Trends & Analysis

The Hidden Cost: FX Margin vs. Transfer Fee

The biggest lesson from 2025 data is that headline fees are misleading. Apps like WorldRemit and Remitly may advertise low or zero transfer fees while embedding profit in the exchange rate spread. Wise charges a visible percentage fee (0.57%+) but uses the mid-market FX rate with zero markup — making it the most cost-transparent option even when not the cheapest. As one analysis noted, the real cost hides in the exchange rate spread, not the headline fee.

Sub-Saharan Africa Remains Most Expensive

At 8.46% average total cost in Q3 2025, Sub-Saharan Africa continues to be the world's most expensive remittance destination by region (World Bank Q3 2025). This compares to 5.30% for South Asia and 5.64% for Latin America. Several SSA corridors — including Angola→Namibia and Ghana→Nigeria — have no SmART-qualifying low-cost services at all.

Fintech Disruption Is Real But Uneven

Nigeria and Kenya corridors have been transformed by fintech competition. However, North African corridors (Algeria, Morocco), Southern African corridors (Angola), and landlocked country corridors (DRC, Ethiopia) remain expensive and underserved. Algeria and DRC lack meaningful fintech competition, and France→Algeria at 6.40% is a stark example of a high-volume corridor that costs more than the global average.

The \$105 Billion Opportunity

With Sub-Saharan Africa receiving a projected \$105 billion in remittances in 2025, reducing average corridor costs from 8.46% to the SDG target of 3% would return approximately \$5.7 billion annually to African families. The fintech wave — led by LemFi, TapTap Send, NALA, and Sendwave — is the primary driver of this cost reduction.

Stablecoins Move From Frontier to Mainstream

What was described as an emerging category one year ago has now reached the inside of mainstream diaspora apps. **Tether's strategic investment in LemFi in May 2026** is the most consequential signal: USDT is being integrated as a settlement layer across LemFi's African and Asian corridors, replacing slow SWIFT rails with near-instant, low-fee stablecoin settlement. This is the first time a major Africa-diaspora fintech has put a stablecoin issuer directly into its infrastructure stack.

Earlier crypto-native players (Juicyway and others, processing \$1.3B+ since 2021 in business flows) demonstrated proof of concept. With LemFi's 2M+ retail users now connected to that rail, stablecoin remittance crosses from B2B niche to consumer infrastructure. The expected impact: further collapse of FX margin costs, especially for high-inflation corridors where USD-pegged value protection benefits recipients.

Conclusion

The remittance landscape for Africans abroad in 2025 is defined by sharp contrasts: some corridors (US→Nigeria, UK→Kenya) are among the cheapest in the world thanks to fintech competition and mobile money infrastructure; others (South Africa as sender, Algeria as receiver) remain stubbornly expensive and underserved. For diaspora senders, the practical guidance is clear:

- **Nigeria:** Use LemFi, TapTap Send, or WorldRemit — costs under 1% are achievable.
- **Kenya:** Sendwave or NALA deliver sub-1% rates via M-Pesa.
- **Ghana:** TapTap Send or Remitly for under 1% total cost.
- **Morocco / Algeria:** Limited low-cost digital options; shop carefully — best available is ~1.55% but averages remain high.
- **South Africa (sending):** Seek specialized operators; avoid traditional banks and Western Union which inflate costs to 10–15%+.
- **Egypt / Ethiopia / DRC:** WorldRemit, Remitly, or LemFi for competitive rates; the market is less developed than West/East African corridors.

The trend line is firmly downward on costs, driven by fintech competition, mobile money penetration, regulatory improvements, and — newly — stablecoin settlement rails entering the consumer stack. The African diaspora — now sending more money home than any government aid program — has become the continent's most powerful financial infrastructure.

Data sources: World Bank Remittance Prices Worldwide Q3 2025 · StatisticsTimes IMF GDP Data 2025 · Central Bank of Nigeria (full-year 2025 inflows) · Central Bank of Egypt (full-year 2025 inflows, Feb 2026 release) · Semafor Remittance Startups Report · Disrupt Africa & The Block (LemFi/Tether, May 2026; LemFi £100M expansion, April 2026) · Technext / The Condia (NALA Rafiki, Dec 2025) · Daba Finance · FunTimes Magazine · World Bank Corridor Data: US-Nigeria · UK-Kenya · UK-Ghana · France-Morocco · US-Egypt · US-South Africa.